🌺 Poinsettia Care & Pinching: Lab Sheet · ANSWER KEY

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 3 · goes with Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions

Name: _____

Question: How does our care affect poinsettia growth and coloring over time?

Materials

poinsettia, care chart, ruler, hand lens

⚠️ Safety

- Nitrile gloves (sap/latex)
- Students never handle pesticides
- Wash hands

Prediction

How many weeks until the bracts are fully colored?
About 8-10 weeks from the start of dark treatment.

Procedure

1. Check moisture; water soil if dry.
2. Inspect for pests.
3. Measure height and count colored bracts weekly.
4. Log on the care chart.

Data

Week	Height (cm)	Bracts colored	Action / observation
1	**20**	**0**	**watered, pinched**
2	**22**	**0**	**no pests**
3	**24**	**2**	**watered**
4	**25**	**5**	**whitefly reported**

Expected results (your class data may differ).

Analysis (Claim, Evidence, Reasoning)

1. Claim: is your plant on track for the sale? Evidence from your chart; reasoning about photoperiod and care.
Answers vary; coloring should increase with long nights.

🔑 *Key written by our team from the class teacher's lab sheets, please check.*